



Department of Nutrition and Food Studies

NUTR-UE 119.003 - Nutrition and Health - Fall 2026

45 hours: 3 credits – Monday at 4:55 PM – Silver Center, Room 408

Instructor: Mitchell Zandes, MS, RD, CDCES, CSCS, NSCA-CPT

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Office Hours: By appointment only

Mailbox: 411 Lafayette, 5th Fl. Room 509

Grader: TBD

Course Description

This course introduces the fundamentals of nutrition science and its impact on human health and society. We will explore nutrient requirements, nutrition recommendations, energy balance, and the connection between diet and chronic diseases. We will also explore topics like weight management, nutrition for fitness and sport, and nutrition during pregnancy.

Course Objectives

By the end of this course, you will be able to:

- Identify the primary food sources and essential functions of nutrients in the human body.
- Explain essential nutrient requirements for growth and development, how these translate into dietary guides, and current knowledge limits.
- Describe the biological, psychological, cultural, and socioeconomic factors that influence dietary choices.
- Describe factors contributing to health inequities in nutrition, including structural bias, social inequities, health disparities, and discrimination.
- Demonstrate knowledge of food's role in promoting a healthy lifestyle.
- Calculate and interpret the nutrient composition of various foods.
- Apply critical thinking skills to nutritional information and health claims.

Required Course Materials

This course is participating in the Follett ACCESS program. The required course material for this course will be delivered digitally via a link available on your course site.

The cost of the platform, which includes the textbook, will be added to your bursar bill as a **“book charge.”** Pricing details can be found on the [NYU Follett ACCESS website](#) or on the [NYU Bookstore site when you log in with your NYU ID or search by course.](#)

- **Connect by McGraw Hill:** Every student is required to have Connect access. We will be using this platform for homework assignments and exams. Purchasing a physical copy is optional and cannot substitute for Connect.
- **NYU Brightspace:** This platform will serve as the primary hub for class announcements, lecture slides, and quizzes. Students can also use it to access the Connect Assignments.

Course Policies and Expectations

Course Policies

- **Late Assignments:** Unless specified otherwise, every assignment must be turned in on the assigned due date by the specified time. Submitting work incorrectly can lead to point deductions. If you run into technical issues during submission, reach out to the instructor before the deadline.
- **Exam Attendance & Absences:** For scheduled conflicts (such as observing a religious holiday), please inform the instructor by email no later than one week prior to the exam. Missing an exam without a valid excuse will earn a zero. Unexpected excused absences are only permitted under verified, extraordinary circumstances.

Etiquette and Behavior

Students are expected to interact respectfully with peers and the instructor. Disruptive behavior or conduct that interferes with the learning environment will not be tolerated and may result in point deductions from your final grade.

Academic Policies and Procedures

All students are required to adhere to NYU Steinhardt’s academic policies and procedures. Review Steinhardt’s policies and procedures at <https://steinhardt.nyu.edu/current-students/academic-policies-and-procedures>

Moses Center Accommodations

Students requiring academic accommodations must register with the [Moses Center for Accessibility and Inclusive Culture](#). Please inform the instructor early in the semester to ensure accommodations (such as extended exam time) are properly arranged.

Using LockDown Browser for Exams

This course requires the use of a LockDown Browser for exams. Watch this [short video](#) to get an understanding of LockDown Browser. Then download and install LockDown Browser from this link: <https://download.respondus.com/lockdown/download.php?id=543490690>

Course Components

- **Attendance (10 points):** Regular attendance is expected. You may miss up to 2 classes without penalty. You are not required to notify the instructor for standard absences. However, missing 6 or more classes will result in a -100 point penalty on your final grade.
- **Diet and Lifestyle Analysis Quizzes (90 points total):** Throughout the course, you will complete three Diet and Lifestyle Analysis Quizzes worth 30 points each. These assignments are designed to connect course concepts with real-world scenarios. For each quiz, you will analyze a one-day dietary and lifestyle profile and be asked to identify areas for improvement and propose healthier alternatives.
- **Connect Assignments (100 points total):** You will complete Connect Assignments worth 10 points each. These assignments will require you to complete readings and answer questions for the chapters covered in the course.
- **Exams (300 points total):** There will be three exams worth 100 points each. Exams will be administered via Connect and will be taken in person during scheduled class time. All exams will be a combination of multiple choice and true/false questions. Students will use their personal electronic devices to complete the exams.

Grading and Evaluation

Grades are assigned using an absolute point system rather than a curved scale, with final evaluations based on a **500-point total**. Please review the following page for details on point allocation and grade determination.

Component	Points
Attendance	10 pts
Diet and Lifestyle Analysis Quizzes	90 pts
Connect Assignments	100 pts
Exam 1	100 pts
Exam 2	100 pts
Exam 3	100 pts
Total	500 pts

No A+		C+	≥ 77% and < 80%
A	≥ 93%	C	≥ 73% and < 77%
A-	≥ 90% and < 93%	C-	≥ 70% and < 73%
B+	≥ 87% and < 90%	D+	≥ 65% and < 70%
B	≥ 83% and < 87%	D	≥ 60% and < 65%
B-	≥ 80% and < 83%	F	< 60%